

Gatepost Partners is building a regional **residential and commercial pest control** company across **North Carolina, South Carolina, Virginia, and Tennessee**. It starts with one founding business with **\$500 thousand to \$3 million of EBITDA**, then grows as neighboring operators join as partners. Owners receive cash at closing, **roll equity into the combined company** as partners, and keep their name on the truck and their crew on the routes. Our equity is committed before a letter of intent is signed.

INVESTMENT APPROACH

FOUNDING COMPANY	PARTNER COMPANIES	TRANSACTION	MANAGEMENT
\$500k to \$3mm Typical EBITDA	Smaller Operators Near existing routes	Majority Recap With partnership rollover	Welcome to Stay Day-to-day role not required

THE THESIS

- **An essential service.** Homes and businesses need pest control in good years and lean ones.
- **Relationships that recur.** Customers stay on a regular plan with a technician they know.
- **Owner-led and local.** Many strong family companies have grown as far as word of mouth will take them.
- **Density pays.** More stops on the same streets lifts technician productivity at nearly the same cost.
- **A growing region.** Raleigh–Durham, coastal Carolina, Richmond, and Tennessee suburbs keep adding households.

THE PARTNERSHIP

01 The founding company

Chris runs it full-time. The team and name stay.

02 Neighbors join

Adjacent operators add stops on the same streets.

03 Grow together

Shared marketing, systems, and buying power; rolled equity owns a piece of the whole.

THE PLATFORM BRINGS

- Marketing around your routes
- Fast lead response, autopay
- Technician pay and careers
- Back office and compliance

WHAT STAYS YOURS

- Your name and phone number
- Your crew and routes
- A role if you want one
- Partnership equity

TARGET SERVICES

Residential Pest	Commercial Pest	Termite and Specialty
■ Quarterly general pest plans ■ Mosquito and tick programs ■ Rodent control and exclusion ■ Wildlife and stinging insects	■ Restaurants and food service ■ Apartments and property managers ■ Medical, schools, and churches ■ Warehouses and retail	■ Termite baiting and renewals ■ Real estate WDI reports ■ Crawlspace moisture control ■ Lawn and ornamental care

ABOUT OUR FOUNDER

Chris Kern founded Gatepost Partners to build a pest control platform alongside the owners who join it. He runs a residential water treatment business, which taught him what a small service company depends on: a technician who shows up, a phone someone answers, and route density. Before that, he spent a handful of years at a lower middle market private equity firm on platform buyouts and add-on acquisitions of founder and family-owned companies, running diligence and financing through closing and working with management teams on budgets, KPIs, and integration. Chris is an MBA candidate at The Wharton School, holds a B.S. in Finance from Florida State University, and plans to move to the market and run the platform day to day.